

Fish facts

Fish evolved more than 500 million years ago, and were the first animals to evolve a backbone. They can be found in a variety of places, from vast oceans to small freshwater lakes. Some fish live on bright coral reefs, while others lurk thousands of feet deeper in pitch-black oceanic trenches.

WHAT IS A FISH?



Vertebrates

The typical fish skeleton consists of a spinal column, skull, ribs, and fin supports.



Cold-blooded

Fish may swim in warm or cold water, but their bodies are the same temperature as the water they live in.



Breathe with gills

Gills located on the side of a fish contain blood that absorbs oxygen from the water.



Scaly skin

Most fish are covered in protective, overlapping plates called scales. Some fish do not have scales.



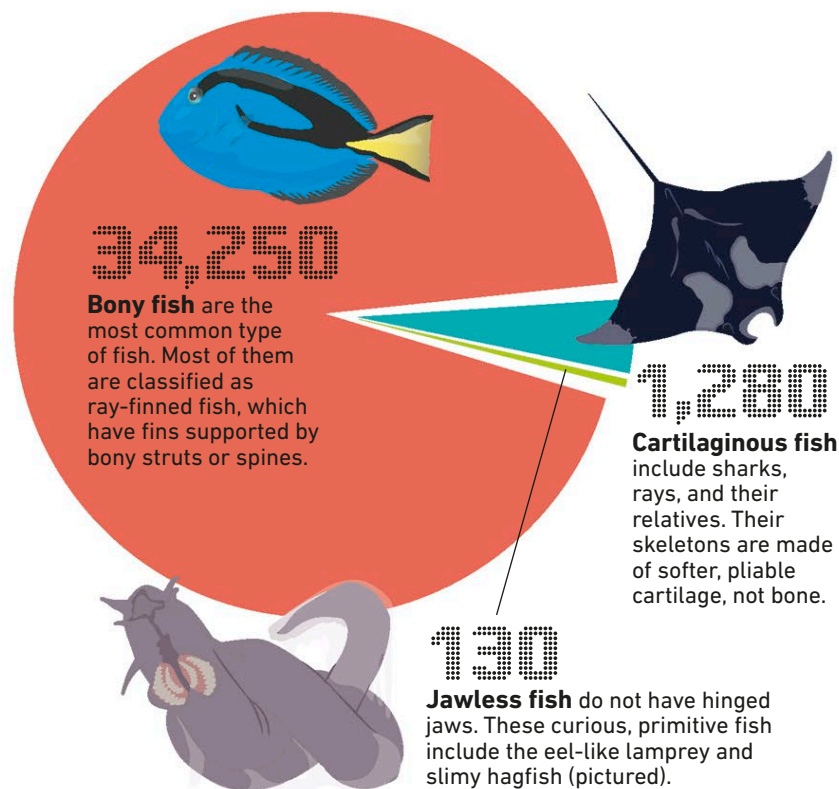
Live in water

Some fish swim in salty oceans, others need fresh water to survive. Some move between the two.

FISH TYPES

ESTIMATED NUMBER OF FISH SPECIES:

35,000



THE **GULF CORVINA** IS THE LOUDEST FISH—WITH A CALL OF **202** DECIBELS, IT'S **LOUDER THAN A PLANE TAKING OFF!**

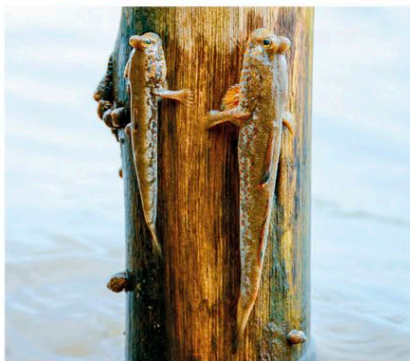


EXTREME HABITATS

Some fish have evolved to survive in the most inhospitable conditions, from the frozen Arctic to dried-up riverbeds.



Arctic cod can survive in sub-zero temperatures, using an antifreeze protein in their blood. This allows them to find food beneath the ice in polar regions, without any competition.



Mudskippers are found in the Indian and Pacific oceans, but they actually prefer the land—and even climb trees! They can keep breathing on land for up to two days at a time.



Lungfish live in rivers and lakes in Africa, Australia, and South America. During dry seasons, they burrow into mud, before cocooning themselves in a mucus that traps life-saving moisture.

LONGEST MIGRATION

DORADO CATFISH MIGRATE

7,200 MILES

(11,600 KM) INLAND, FROM THE ANDES TO THE AMAZON AND BACK.

